

David Le Chan

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Education

M.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering (ECE) Expected May 2027

Carnegie Mellon University (CMU) | Pittsburgh, PA

- Reconfigurable Logic, Hardware Verification, Digital Integrated Circuit Design (SRAMs), Post-Silicon Hardware Testing, Memory Devices, Innovation Strategy and Management

B.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering (ECE) Expected May 2026

Carnegie Mellon University (CMU) | Pittsburgh, PA

- GPA: 3.8/4.0; 6x *College of Engineering Dean's List Recipient*
- Digital IC Tapeout, Computer Architecture, Digital Design Verification, Microelectronic Circuits, Machine Learning, Computer Systems, Signal Analysis, Linear Algebra, Multivariable Calculus, Statistics, Leadership

Work Experience

FPGA & Electrical Engineering Intern May 2025 - August 2025

KLA Corporation, BBP Division | Milpitas, CA

- Upgraded FPGA firmware for high-speed lossless image compression on KLA's flagship wafer inspection tool line
- Implemented subsystems via Verilog and Vivado IP Integrator, verifying functionality through Questa simulation
- Deployed designs on PCIe-based Alveo accelerator cards, performing place-and-route optimization and hardware-level validation to quantify performance and ensure reliability

Undergraduate Research Assistant May 2024 - Present

IO Harness Project, CMU ECE | Pittsburgh, PA

- Designing a standardized harness to reduce infrastructure redevelopment work for IC tapeouts; first prototype fabricated on TSMC 180 nm under active testing
- Architecting system features and writing SystemVerilog RTL for I2C, UART, and SPI communication blocks

Power Electronics & Programming Intern June 2022 - January 2024

Tau Motors | Redwood City, CA

- Prototyped power circuits for wound-field electric motors, including PCB layout, assembly, and bench testing
- Developed custom Python-based inventory management software and systems to accelerate hardware iterations

Leadership and Projects

Hybrid FFT/NTT Accelerator SoC (28nm Tapeout) January 2026 - Present

- End-to-end design of a novel hybrid accelerator that supports both FFT and NTT operations through hardware reuse
- Integrated our hybrid accelerator with a VexRISC-V core to create a test SoC in SpinalHDL
- Designed a custom cocotb-based test orchestrator for multi-level verification at all design stages

Head Teaching Assistant (TA), Introduction to ECE (18-100) January 2025 - January 2026

- Leading a 40 TA team to foster an emotionally-safe environment where 180 first-year students can explore ECE, form lasting friendships, and develop strong engineering habits
- Continuously redesigning lab curriculum, such as the AM Radio lab with PCB and soldering components, to give students hands-on experience with real hardware assembly and industry design workflows
- Establishing automated Python scripts and feedback systems to streamline course operations, reducing administrative overhead and empowering TAs to focus on mentorship and teaching quality